

Install Ubuntu Server & Configure SSH for Wazuh

1. Download Ubuntu Server

After taking into consideration the prerequisites on operating system, and hardware to install WAZUH SIEM, the operating system we are going to use to install WAZUH SIEM is **Ubuntu 24.04**.

Do: go to Ubuntu web site (<https://ubuntu.com/>) click on download. Here you will find two versions: **Desktop and server**.

Most of the time, different people and different professionals use Ubuntu desktop. But I would prefer to use **server** because it consumes fewer resources compared to the desktop version, and the installation and performance on this are much smoother.

Do: click on download.(make sure to have Download 24.04.x LTS)

2. Create the Virtual Machine

Open Oracle VM VirtualBox and configure the new virtual machine:

1. Click **New**, specify a VM name, and select the downloaded Ubuntu Server ISO image.
2. Uncheck **Skip unattended installation** (or "Proceed with unattended installation") to ensure manual control over setup.
3. Click **Finish**.

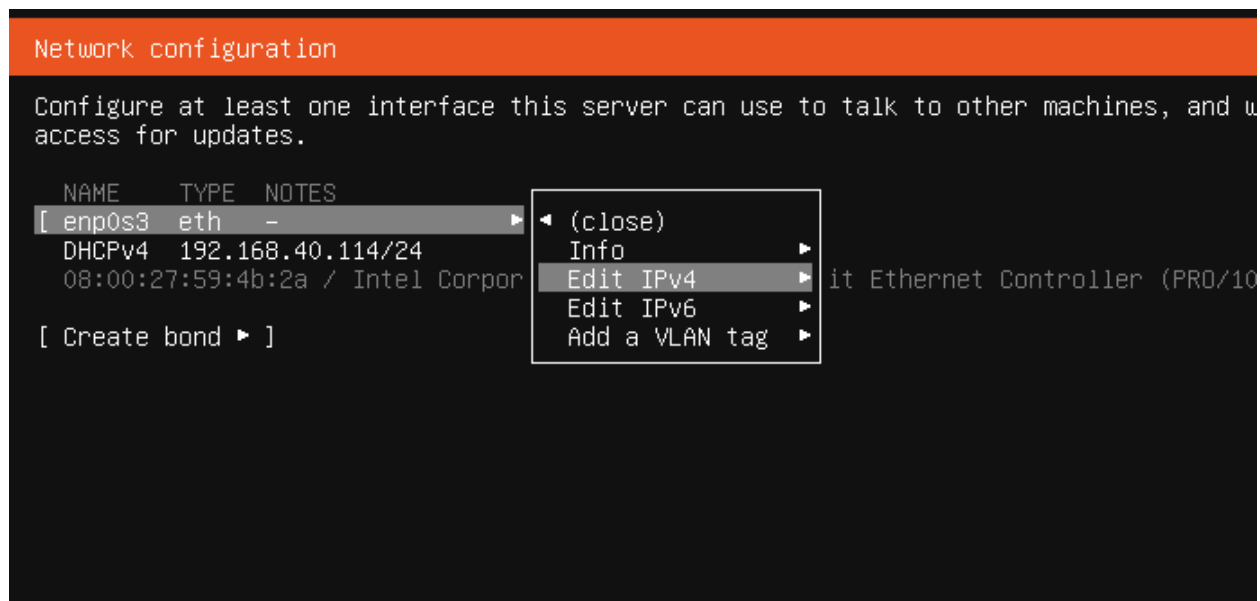
3. Configure VirtualBox Hardware Settings

Access the VM settings (Settings) and adjust the following parameters:

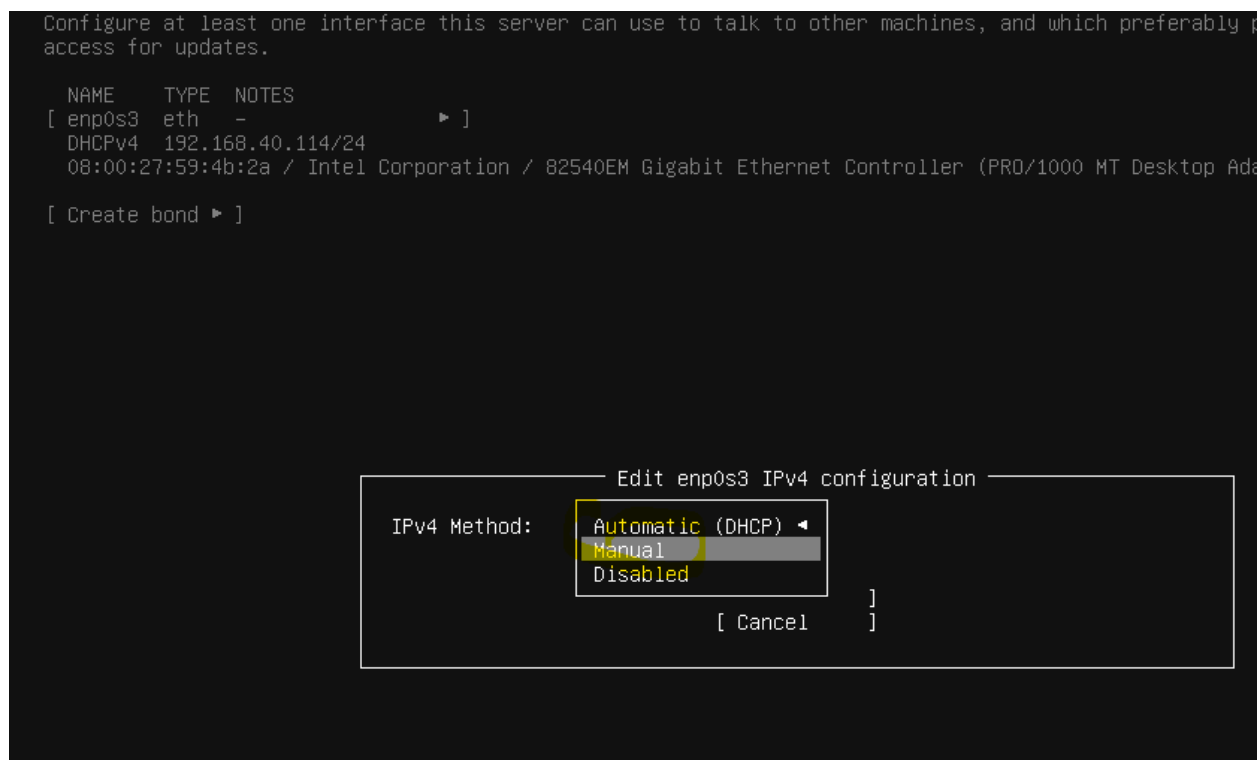
- **General -> Advanced:** Set **Shared Clipboard** and **Drag and Drop** to **Bidirectional**.
- **System -> Motherboard:** Allocate adequate RAM (at least 6 GB recommended for a Wazuh server).
- **System -> Processor:** Assign 4 vCPUs.
- **Display:** Increase video memory from 16 MB to **128 MB**.
- **Audio:** Uncheck **Enable Audio** to disable unneeded virtual hardware.
- **Network:** Change the adapter mode from **NAT** to **Bridged Adapter** to allow direct integration with your physical network infrastructure.

4. Execute the Installation

1. Click **Start** to boot the virtual machine and select the primary installation option.
2. Choose your preferred language and proceed through the initial installer prompts.
3. **Configure Static IP:** During network configuration, assign a permanent static IP address to your Wazuh server to ensure stable connectivity and prevent addressing shifts across system reboots.



So, by choosing manual,



we have to provide its subnet mask here. To check subnet mask go to CMD and enter ipconfig. It will show you what its default gateway is.

Wireless LAN adapter Wi-Fi:

```
Connection-specific DNS Suffix . : hsd1.md.comcast.net
IPv6 Address. . . . . : 2601:152:4c7e:4460::df81
IPv6 Address. . . . . : 2601:152:4c7e:4460:3a25:fe33:354:3cf4
Temporary IPv6 Address. . . . . : 2601:152:4c7e:4460:b114:4ebf:9d29:8fdb
Link-local IPv6 Address . . . . . : fe80::9af4:896:50c0:e30b%18
IPv4 Address. . . . . : 192.168.40.155
Subnet Mask . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
Default Gateway . . . . . : fe80::a88a:6fff:fe0a:1252%18
                             192.168.40.1
```

So, I will choose for Subnet 192.168.40.0/24. That I want to assign. My WAZUH server is 192.168.40.40, and the default gateway is 192.168.40.1. And here I provide Google DNS along with Cloudflare DNS 8.8.8.8, 1.1.1.1. Choose save and enter.

```
NAME      TYPE      NOTES
[ enp0s3  eth    -          ]
DHCPv4    192.168.40.114/24
08:00:27:59:4b:2a / Intel Corporation / 82540EM Gigabit Ethernet Controller (PRO/1000 MT Desktop Ad
[ Create bond ► ]
```

Edit enp0s3 IPv4 configuration

IPv4 Method: [Manual ▼]

Subnet: 192.168.40.0/24

Address: 192.168.40.40

Gateway: 192.168.40.1

Name servers: 8.8.8.8, 1.1.1.1
IP addresses, comma separated

Search domains:
Domains, comma separated

[Save]
[Cancel]

Okay, choose done, hit enter. Done.

Okay, we need to perform one thing here. Remove PK from here and make it US instead. Hit enter. When you hit enter, When you hit enter, it will fetch the US archives or its mirror locations. It gives an error on PK, so you have to change it to US. After that, hit enter. Navigate through it with tab and choose done. Hit enter. Hit enter. Continue. Here, give it any name. Ubuntu, WAZU. Server. Continue.

Profile configuration

Enter the username and password you will use to log in to the system. You can con
password is still needed for sudo.

Your name: ubuntu

Your servers name: wazuh-server
The name it uses when it talks to other computers.

Pick a username: tims

Choose a password: *****

Confirm your password: *****

Here, check install open SSH server. Pressing space will check it. Okay, choose done, hit enter.

SSH configuration

You can choose to install the OpenSSH server p

☒ Install OpenSSH server

☒ Allow password authentication over SSH

[Import SSH key ►]

AUTHORIZED KEYS

No authorized key

Once the installation script is initiated, allow approximately 15 minutes for the setup process to complete.

Establish an SSH session to your server by entering your username and target IP address:

`ssh username@server_ip`

When prompted to accept the host's authenticity fingerprint, type yes and press Enter. Enter your account password when requested to complete authentication.

With an active SSH session established, update and upgrade your system package repositories to ensure the environment is current: `sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y`



Ubuntu
Server 24.04 LTS

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Step-by-Step Guide to Prepare Your Ubuntu Server for Wazuh SIEM

Download

Configure

Install

Secure

Ready for Wazuh



WAZUH
Open Source Security
for a Safer World

1 Download Ubuntu Server

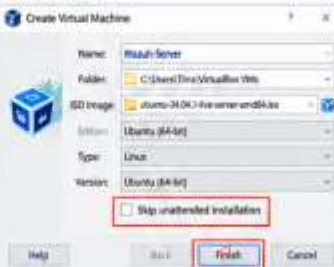
- Go to the Ubuntu website: <https://ubuntu.com/>
- Click on **Download**.
- You will see two versions: **Desktop** and **Server**.
- Choose **Ubuntu Server (recommended)**.
- Download the latest LTS version (**24.04.x LTS**).



Tip: Use the Server version. It consumes fewer resources and provides better performance for Wazuh.

2 Create the Virtual Machine

- Open Oracle VM **VirtualBox**.
- Click **New**.
- Enter a VM name (e.g., **Wazuh-Server**).
- Select the downloaded **Ubuntu Server** ISO image.
- Uncheck **Skip unattended installation** to keep manual control.
- Click **Finish**.



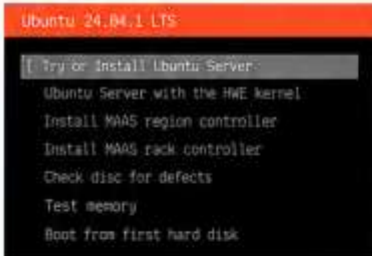
3 Configure VirtualBox Hardware Settings

After creating the VM, open **Settings** and adjust:

- General** → **Advanced**: Set **Shared Clipboard** and **Drag & Drop** to **Bidirectional**.
- System** → **Motherboard**: Allocate at least **6 GB RAM** (recommended for Wazuh server).
- System** → **Processor**: Assign **4 vCPUs**.
- Display**: Increase video memory from **16 MB** to **128 MB**.
- Audio**: Uncheck **Enable Audio** (not needed).
- Network**: Change from **NAT** to **Bridged Adapter** (to access your physical network).

4 Execute the Installation

- Click **Start** to boot the virtual machine.
- Select the primary installation option.
- Choose your preferred language.
- Follow the installer prompts.
- Configure a static IP address (manual) to ensure stable connectivity.



Select **Try or Install Ubuntu Server** and press **Enter**.

5 Configure Network (Static IP)

- Choose **Manual** during network configuration.
- Enter your network details (example below).



Example Configuration:

- Subnet: 192.168.40.0/24
- IP Address: 192.168.40.48
- Gateway: 192.168.40.1
- DNS: 8.8.8.8, 1.1.1.1 (Google & Cloudflare)

6 System Configuration

- Set the location (choose **US** instead of **PK** if needed).
- Enter server information (example).



If you see an error with **PK**, change it to **US** to use the US archive mirrors.

7 Install OpenSSH Server

- During the installation, select **Install OpenSSH server** (press **Space** to check).



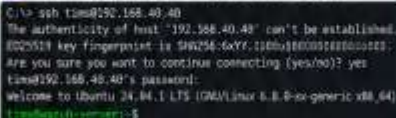
8 Complete Installation

- Wait for the installation to complete (about 15 minutes).
- When finished, choose **Done** and reboot if required.



9 Connect via SSH

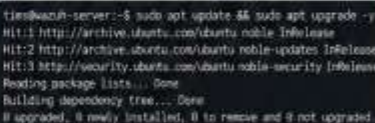
- Open your terminal (PowerShell, CMD, or Linux terminal).
- Connect using your username and server IP address.



Type **yes** to accept the fingerprint, then enter your password.

10 Update Your System

After connecting, update and upgrade your system:



Your Ubuntu server is **now ready for Wazuh installation!**



Next Steps

- Install Wazuh server (manager)
- Install Wazuh agents (endpoints)
- Configure rules and monitoring
- Start detecting threats!

"Knowledge shared is a safer world."
— Tims TCHOUAMOU



Author

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Cybersecurity Enthusiast | SOC Content Creator
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